



GENERATION LINKSTER



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Expemo code:
1H8M-M1LA-49C



1

Warm up

In pairs, discuss the questions below.

1. Do you know the difference between baby boomers, Generation X and millennials?
2. Can you name any other generations?
3. Which generation are you part of? Would you like to belong to a different generation?

2

Focus on vocabulary

Match the nouns below to the definitions.

- | | |
|---------------|---|
| 1. expert | a. a country's business and trade and any money it creates |
| 2. toddler | b. a subject that many people are talking about |
| 3. society | c. a group of people who are about the same age in a society |
| 4. issue | d. a person who has a lot of knowledge about a subject |
| 5. generation | e. a young child that is learning to walk |
| 6. economy | f. the possibility that something bad is going to happen |
| 7. landline | g. people living together somewhere with laws which say how they can behave |
| 8. threat | h. a telephone that is connected to a system by wires |



3

Finding vocabulary

Find a word or phrase in the text which means

1. _____ people born after the Second World War (n, para. A)
2. _____ have to deal with situations that make you feel worried or stressed (phr., para. B)
3. _____ watch several episodes of a television programme, one after the other (phr., para. C)
4. _____ talking in person and not through electronic messages (phr., para. C)
5. _____ happy to (do something) (phr., para. D)
6. _____ accept that people believe in different things (phr., para. D)
7. _____ show the things that are wrong with someone or something (v, para. E)
8. _____ not aware of changes (idiom, para. E)

4

Reading comprehension

Read the sentences below. Put T (true) or false (F) next to each statement. Then, read the article to confirm or correct your answers.

1. The Linkster generation haven't known a world without technology. _____
2. Millennials can't remember what life was like before social media. _____
3. Linksters might never go into a real bank in their lives. _____
4. Linksters won't have problems communicating face-to-face with people. _____
5. Generation X parents both go out to work. _____
6. Each new generation often thinks that other generations are responsible for their problems. _____





What comes after millennials? Meet the generation known as the 'The Linksters'

Will the young people born after 2002, sometimes called Generation Z, feel the same anger that millennials do when they become adults?

- A. Experts have said and written a lot about millennials, Generation X and baby boomers, but have you heard of the 'Linkster generation'? Meagan Johnson, speaker, author and expert on differences between generations, describes anyone born after 2002 as part of the Linkster Generation or Generation Z. "We chose the term Linkster Generation because it is the first generation to be linked into technology from day one," Johnson says. She also says that because of millennials, society is focused on technology and this has forced other generations to use it. But, she adds, there are millennials that can remember using dial-up phones and a life before social media.
- B. So, the Linkster Generation - about 18 percent of the world's population - grew up with social media, smartphones and apps. Linksters know the advantages of social media, the internet and advanced technology, but also have to learn to cope with the pressure they create. Johnson says that the Linkster Generation probably grew up in a home where people used cell phones and there was no landline. She adds that they may never write a cheque or walk into a traditional bank.
- C. Millennials (those born after 1981 and before 2002) are often known as the generation which prefers binge-watching Netflix series instead of going to the cinema, texting instead of calling and using apps to date instead of meeting in bars. Therefore, Linksters may have problems when they have to communicate with someone face-to-face. For example, it is quite normal to see a toddler in a café playing games on their parent's phone or to have a young relative that knows what Snapchat is. Johnson says it is important that we carry on teaching Linksters how important real-life conversation is.
- D. The other way that this generation will be different is family structure. The parents of Linksters will be a mixture of baby boomers (born between 1946 and 1964) and Generation X parents (usually born between 1965 and 1980.) Johnson says that more and more Generation X parents are deciding that one parent should stay at home, and that it is often the male parent that chooses to do this. People believe that each generation gets more liberal and open-minded, so it is more likely that Linksters will be willing to tolerate other people's beliefs. They have also never experienced a time when climate change is not a serious threat and issue.
- E. Johnson says that she thinks that the Linkster Generation will take the idea of different lifestyles to a new level. She also believes there is no need to criticise members of one generation and give them a negative image. Millennials have been called lazy and people say they act like they should get everything they want. Generation X sometimes only seem interested in themselves, but work hard and play hard. Millennials often think that baby boomers are out of touch and have ruined the economy for them. Johnson says it is important to remember that each generation has a habit of being unfair to other generations.

Sources: *The Independent*, *Metro*





5

Phrases

Complete the sentences below with a phrase from the text.

carry on

focus on

grow up

walk into

1. If you have to _____ work, make sure you are in a quiet place.
2. Many children now _____ with technology all around them.
3. Sometimes when you _____ a shop, there is an assistant there to help you.
4. It is difficult to _____ talking to someone when they are texting.

6

Talking point

Discuss any of the questions below in pairs or small groups.

1. What do you think the advantages and disadvantages of 'Generation Linkster' are?
2. Do you agree with the qualities associated with your generation?
3. What generation do you think will come after the Linksters?

